2023年12月四级真题第2套

原卷 / Question Paper · 年份 2023 | 月份 12 | 第 二 套 | 时长 125 分钟 | 满分 710（及格 425）

Part I 写作 (Writing)

Directions: the university newspaper is inviting submissions from the students for its coming edition on the recent development in their hometown. You are now to write an essay for submission. You will have 30 minutes to write the essay. You should write at least 120 words but no more than 180 words.

建议时间：30 分钟 | 字数：120-180 | 分值：15

作答区

Part II 听力理解 (Listening Comprehension)

Section A news

短新闻

听力音频：audio/SectionA.mp3（见离线包 papers 目录对应 audio 文件夹）

1. **Why did the police officer stop the SUV car?**
   - A. He noticed the driver was too young to drive.
   - B. He found there was no one sitting at the wheel.
   - C. He thought something must be wrong with the driver.
   - D. He saw the driver changing lanes much too frequently.
2. **What did the boy tell the police officers he was planning to do?**
   - A. Buy a sports car.
   - B. Drive across town.
   - C. Leave California.
   - D. Visit his sister.
3. **What does the report say we have not yet understood about mobile phones?**
   - A. How they change the way we shop.
   - B. How they alter human skeletons.
   - C. How they cause increased headaches.
   - D. How they affect our communication.
4. **What happens to the skin when rubbed or pressed constantly?**
   - A. It loosens.
   - B. It brightens.
   - C. It hardens.
   - D. It softens.
5. **What is the village going to do for the cat named Wilbur?**
   - A. Create Internet pages for him.
   - B. Ask a local pet shop to adopt him.
   - C. Name an orange tree after him.
   - D. Hold a birthday party for him.
6. **What do we learn from the report about the cat?**
   - A. He is a bold and aggressive pet.
   - B. He pays regular visits to village shops.
   - C. He once bit a doctor s receptionist.
   - D. He often seeks food from strangers.
7. **What does the pub owner Leslie Harper say about the cat?**
   - A. He is fond of luxury cat food.
   - B. He likes to stay in villagers’ houses.
   - C. He knows everybody in the village.
   - D. He often seeks food around her pub.

Section B conversations

长对话

听力音频：audio/SectionB.mp3（见离线包 papers 目录对应 audio 文件夹）

1. **What's are the speakers talking about in this conversation?**
   - A. Who to order the food.
   - B. Whether to have sandwiches.
   - C. When to go for their meal.
   - D. Where to have their lunch.
2. **Where did the speakers see Bridget Clark the famous movie star?**
   - A. In the shopping center nearby.
   - B. In the expensive Italian style diner.
   - C. At the Sandwich Place on Camden Street.
   - D. At the American restaurant they frequent.
3. **Why does the woman say she needs to get back by 2030?**
   - A. There is to be a conference call.
   - B. She has to meet with her boss then.
   - C. There will be crowds of people waiting for her.
   - D. She will have a photo taken with Brigette Clark.
4. **Why does the woman say Jeremy should throw his soup in the bin?**
   - A. She knows Jeremy dislikes having soup for lunch.
   - B. She doesn’t think his wife cooks well.
   - C. She feels Jeremy would rather dine out.
   - D. She has found the soup smells terrible.
5. **Who is the man talking to in the conversation?**
   - A. A landlady.
   - B. A waitress.
   - C. A receptionist.
   - D. A saleswoman.
6. **What do we learn about the man's father-in-law from the conversation?**
   - A. He was involved in a terrible car accident last April.
   - B. He has much difficulty getting up and down stairs.
   - C. He is expected to undergo a knee operation.
   - D. He prefers to stay next door to the children.
7. **Why does the man say they will explore all the options available?**
   - A. To please his parents- in-law.
   - B. To find the best trip for his kids.
   - C. To satisfy his curiosity.
   - D. To compare prices.
8. **What does the woman suggest the man and his family do close to the end of the conversation?**
   - A. Visit a local art gallery.
   - B. Go on a boat trip.
   - C. Take some photos of the islands.
   - D. Try her hand-made clothing.

Section C passages

听力篇章

听力音频：audio/SectionC.mp3（见离线包 papers 目录对应 audio 文件夹）

1. **What does the passive say about artificial intelligence agents?**
   - A. They are more intelligent than many of us.
   - B. They have already become our new friends.
   - C. They have begun to affect our social behavior.
   - D. They play increasingly more important roles.
2. **What does the new study want to find out about using an artificial intelligence agents?**
   - A. Whether it might have any effect on the way we negotiate.
   - B. Whether it might actually outperform human negotiators.
   - C. Whether it can facilitate business transactions.
   - D. Whether it can speed up legal procedures.
3. **What did participants tend to do when assigned an AI agent to negotiate on their behalf.**
   - A. Choose to be tough.
   - B. Sympathize with their opponent.
   - C. Use deceptive strategies.
   - D. Appear to be pleasant.
4. **What do we learn about the benefits the participants gained from the healthy cooking course?**
   - A. They were perceived differently by some academics.
   - B. They still existed six months after the course ended.
   - C. They varied greatly among the course participants.
   - D. They were only measurable within seven weeks.
5. **What do the new research findings suggest about mental health benefits?**
   - A. They can be easily seen among participants in a healthy weight range.
   - B. They are related to participants’ initial cooking skills.
   - C. They are linked to cooking confidence and cooking satisfaction.
   - D. They actually result from eating more fruits and vegetables.
6. **What plays a role in determining who benefits most from learning to cook?**
   - A. Gender.
   - B. Confidence.
   - C. Health.
   - D. Practice.
7. **What does research show about our personal space?**
   - A. It keeps others away.
   - B. It causes discomfort.
   - C. It remains visible.
   - D. It varies in size.
8. **What happens if a mere acquaintance enters our intimate space?**
   - A. It makes us feel uncomfortable.
   - B. It renders the acquaintance a stranger.
   - C. It brings the acquaintance closer to us.
   - D. It causes the bubble around us to vanish.
9. **Where the people feel comfortable interacting with new acquaintances or strangers.**
   - A. In personal space.
   - B. In social space.
   - C. Within a distance of 18 inches.
   - D. Over 2 feet away from one another.
10. **When are the sizes of our personal bubbles fixed?**
    - A. When we begin to feel fear.
    - B. When we develop a sense of space.
    - C. When we are 3 or 4 years old.
    - D. When we enter our teens.

Part III 阅读理解 (Reading Comprehension)

Section A 选词填空

Word Bank（词库）

A) boost
B) case
C) casually
D) efficiency
E) estate
F) exhausted
G) faculty
H) interfere
I) normal
J) prevalent
K) relative
L) removed
M) scratch
N) shaped
O) surprisingly

A number of studies have looked at how family life can affect productivity and satisfaction in the workplace. However, there has been **__26__** little research on the influence of leisure activities. So Ciara Kelly and colleagues recruited 129 hobbyists to look at how the time spent on their hobbies **__27__** their work life.
The researchers found that when participants spent longer than **__28__** on their leisure activity, their belief in their ability to perform their job was strengthened. But this was only the **__29__** when they had a serious hobby that was dissimilar to their job, or when their hobby was similar to their work but they only did it **__30__**. When their hobby was both serious and similar to their job, then spending more time on it actually decreased their work **__31__**.
Why might that be? To maintain a serious hobby, people need to invest significant psychological resources, say the authors—so if the activity has the same kinds of demands as their work, they may be left **__32__** and unable to perform well at their job. But if their hobby is quite different from their career, it may not **__33__** in the same way but instead help them develop other knowledge and skills that can **__34__** their confidence at work. “Consider a scientist who is a keen rock climber,” says Kelly. “Since climbing is so far **__35__** from their day-to-day work activities, they can still recover from the demands of their job with plenty of resources.”

空格题号：26、27、28、29、30、31、32、33、34、35

Section B 段落匹配

Directions: 阅读下列段落，为每个句子选出所对应的段落。每个段落可能被选一次、多次或不被选择。

A Attitudes towards paternity leave (陪产假) have drastically changed in America in the last five years as more fathers feel comfortable taking extended time off, but gender bias persists when it comes to career prospects and the home, according to a new study of working parents.

B Research by the Boston College Center for Work & Family, which surveyed new parents at four large US companies who were qualified for taking at least six weeks paid parental leave, found that 81% of the 1,240 employees surveyed said the notion of fathers taking leave has become more acceptable.

C Of those surveyed, 62% of fathers took the maximum amount of time off compared to 93% of mothers, and around three-quarters of workers said their employer was equally supportive of mothers and fathers taking parental leave and over half said leave policies had made workplace culture better.

D The US is one of only three countries in the world not to offer statutory (法定的) paid leave, but increasingly states and companies are starting to take up the issue. So far, eight states and the District of Columbia have their own paid family leave laws.

E Brad Harrington, executive director of the center and lead author of the study, estimates only 20% to 30% of companies in the US offer paid parental leave. He feels the research findings reflect an obvious change in corporate attitudes to new fathers taking time off.

F shocking to me. I did not expect 80% of people to say the organisation finds dads taking this leave acceptable and three-quarters to say it’s equally supportive of women and men taking Harrington said.

G The previous study found that nearly three-quarters of fathers saw two to four weeks as an appropriate duration for paternity leave and 76% said they would prefer not to take all their time off at once.

H Since then, there have been a number of legal cases against companies involving paternity leave—including cases against JPMorgan Chase and Estee Lauder—which have helped put pressure on companies to make their parental leave policies gender neutral.

I However, the study also shows how traditional gender roles endure both at work, where more women than men reported changes in their perceived career potential, and at home—even among workers who claim to have a strong desire for equality.

J The vast majority of men, 97%, said one of the top reasons to take leave was to share caregiving with their partner. But when they were asked about how caregiving and household tasks were divided, their answers painted a different picture. While about 75% of employees said both genders should give the same amount of care, the majority of men and nearly half of women admitted that in reality the female actually did most of it. A tiny fraction, 2%, of men said they did more of the childcare.

K different. Of the women surveyed, 32% reported a downturn in their job satisfaction, while 14% said it increased. In comparison, 17% of men said their job satisfaction went down and 20% said it went up. Meanwhile, more women reported an increase in their responsibilities and manager expectations after childbirth. Half of the women said they used flexible work arrangements after becoming a parent, while just 27% of men did. Similar percentages of men and women said they enjoyed their careers and that it gave them a sense of achievement, while around half of women and 44% of men said it was a key part of their identity.

L On the subject of career advancement, 59% of women and 49% of men said leave could be limiting and both genders said they feared it would have an impact on their progress long-term. But on opportunity for promotion, more than double the number of women, 30% compared with 15% of men, believed their chances to be lower after becoming a parent. Despite progress, the struggle for women to reach the highest positions of power is demonstrated in this year’s Fortune 500 list, which featured a record 33 female CEOs, but this still represents a tiny fraction of the total.

M Harrington said culture change depends on companies putting more focus on men and their responsibilities. “By that I mean companies need to give men paternity leave and encourage men to take time off to be with their kids early on in the kids’ life. They also need to recognise that men have to make significant adjustments when they become parents. Companies cannot do all these things to enhance women’s advancement and then turn around and say, ‘Oh, but we don’t expect the men to take over for the women at home.’ ”

N In May, the American Civil Liberties Union (ACLU) and Outten & Golden LLP announced a historic class-action $5m settlement with JPMorgan Chase on behalf of male employees who claim they were illegally denied access to paid parental leave. Derek Rotondo, 35, filed the discrimination charge against his company after he was allegedly told by his HR department that mothers were considered primary caregivers. Thus, they were allowed to take 16 weeks of paid parental leave. Fathers, however, could take just two weeks.

O The father of two from Columbus, Ohio, who still works at the company as an associate and investigator, said he has witnessed a ” effect (多米诺效应) ” across companies since the settlement, but that there is still substantial progress to be made towards changing attitudes towards paternity leave.

P “I do think there’s still some way to go ... there’s still going to be sort of the unstated expectation for new dads to essentially come right back to work, but I think the research is showing that’s starting to change.” He said equal parental leave is an essential component to creating gender equality in the workplace. “The old standard of women staying home, having babies and cooking doesn’t apply and hasn’t applied for a long time.”

待匹配句子

36. In the absence of Federal legislation, some states in the US have passed laws concerning paid family leave.

37. Most fathers admitted that even during their paternity leave they actually did much less childcare than the mother.

38. According to one father, equal parental leave is indispensable to achieving gender equality in the workplace.

39. One survey indicated there is now less objection to paternity leave.

40. Compared to five years ago, according to one researcher, many more people said their organisation gave the same support to men and women taking parental leave.

41. One study finds that even workers who claim to desire gender equality stick to traditional gender roles both at work and at home.

42. The majority of workers surveyed said parental leave policies had improved workplace culture.

43. In spite of progress, the number of women in top positions of big companies remains extremely small.

44. According to one estimate, less than one third of companies in the US provide paid parental leave.

45. A number of lawsuits have pressured companies to formulate gender neutral policies on parental leave.

Section C 阅读理解

Passage One

Having a rival can keep you committed to achieving your goals and enhance your overall performance. But before you go out and find an entrepreneur to outcompete, it’s important to understand and avoid the traps that often come with rivalry. After all, competitive rivalry can also hinder effective decision-making and increase your willingness to take risks, behaviors that can ultimately hurt your venture’s success.

Finding someone you’re committed to outcompeting can be a great way to stay focused on your goals and push your venture to the next level. But when you’re intently focused on outperforming your rivals, you may begin to develop a “win -at-all-costs” mentality that causes you to ignore how you achieve success. One group of researchers, for example, examined the link between rivalry and unethical behavior. They found that when people compete against their rivals, they are more willing to behave unethically to win. But such behavior may stain your reputation and strain relationships important to your success. One way to avoid this trap is to stop and reflect on what’s important. While outperforming your rivals may provide short-term benefits, the loss of your integrity will have long-term consequences.

One reason having a rival can enhance your venture’s performance is that it creates a level of excitement that drives you to work harder. But this eagerness to win may also hurt your venture’s success, particularly when it causes you to make impulsive, insensible decisions. But it’s possible to avoid such costly mistakes by making a habit of engaging in critical thinking, such as considering opposing viewpoints and conducting cost-benefit analyses, especially for those decisions that are complex and can determine the future of your venture.

The sense of eagerness that comes with having a rival can not only cause you to make poorer decisions, but it can also lead you to take greater risks that put your venture in peril. One way you can overcome the risk-inducing effects of rivalry that stand to endanger your venture’s success is to remain attentive to your emotional state and actively monitor how such feelings are affecting your decision-making.

1. **How can competitive rivalry benefit entrepreneurs according to the passage?**
   - A. By enabling them to outcompete other entrepreneurs.
   - B. By enabling them to make their venture a success.
   - C. By helping them to reach long-term goals.
   - D. By helping them to stay goal-oriented.
2. **What is one of the traps entrepreneurs may often fall into when competing with rivals?**
   - A. They may adopt strategies that are bound to ruin their venture.
   - B. They may resort to unethical means to outperform their rivals.
   - C. They may be too eager to succeed while ignoring the huge labor cost.
   - D. They may be intently focused on winning at the current market level.
3. **What are entrepreneurs advised to do to avoid traps that often accompany rivalry?**
   - A. Deliberate on what really matters.
   - B. Prioritize reaping immediate benefits.
   - C. Estimate the long-term consequences.
   - D. Reflect on what successes are achievable.
4. **How can entrepreneurs avoid making impulsive and insensible decisions?**
   - A. By engaging themselves in critical reasoning.
   - B. By developing a habit of keeping their integrity.
   - C. By criticizing themselves for previous poor performances.
   - D. By refraining from being too excited about their successes.
5. **How can entrepreneurs overcome the risk inducing effects of rivalry?**
   - A. By paying close attention to their current performance.
   - B. By taking steps that stand to endanger their rivals’ success.
   - C. By monitoring how their decision- making impacts their mentality.
   - D. By keeping their emotions in check to avoid making poor decisions.

Passage Two

A multitasker is one who can perform two or more tasks effectively at the same time, which—apart from the obvious differences—is similar to what a computer does. The concept does indeed come from the realms of technology, where it is used to refer to an operating system that can execute multiple tasks at the same time. However, the question is: can a person really be a multitasker?

For most scientists, the answer is no. So much so that, according to experts in neuroscience (神经系 统科学), our brains do not handle multitasking situations well. As soon as two tasks require our attention, productivity suffers. What we call multitasking, therefore, is in reality the ability to move more or less quickly from one task to another. This requires two essential conditions: that one of the tasks needs to be automatic, like walking or eating, and that they both need different mental processes. Answering the phone and writing at the same time, for example.

However, on the other side of the coin there are people who maintain that it is possible to be, or at least seem to be, multitasking. A recent study concluded that regardless of whether people are actually handling several tasks or not, the mere fact that they perceive this activity as multitasking has a positive effect on their performance.

The business perspective offers a different view: multitasking is understood as the ability to adapt to all types of environment within a company and effectively undertake different activities within a set time frame. Indeed, many companies look for people who are skilled in multitasking to improve their productivity. From this different perspective, you can not only be multitasking but this ability can also be taught: something that is easier in fluid organisations, which favour flexibility in their working practices.

The benefits of multitasking are clear. Being quicker and more efficient increases our performance and the number of tasks completed. But having to pay attention to several things at once means that the powers of concentration are reduced and that can lead to more mistakes.

1. **What does a “multitasker” originally refer to?**
   - A. An operating system capable of doing several tasks at once.
   - B. A skilled worker executing more than one task at the same time.
   - C. A sophisticated technology doing several tasks effectively at once.
   - D. An efficient person able to perform multiple tasks at the same time.
2. **Why can’t people really be multitaskers according to neuroscientists?**
   - A. They are not sufficiently exposed to multitasking situations.
   - B. They are not comparable to mechanical operating systems.
   - C. Their brains do not allow them to multitask.
   - D. Their attention span cannot be expanded.
3. **What do we learn from the conclusion of a recent study on multitasking?**
   - A. People make greater achievements by maintaining whatever they are doing is multitasking.
   - B. People’s performance benefits from the perception of what they are doing as multitasking.
   - C. People’s active mental processes exert a positive effect on their multitasking.
   - D. People can improve their capabilities by handling multitasking situations.
4. **How does the business world view multitasking?**
   - A. It is a rare skill often found in fluid organisations.
   - B. It is an adaptable capability required of all workers.
   - C. It is an essential quality many employees lack.
   - D. It is a desirable ability that can be developed.
5. **What does the author imply we should do if we have to focus on some task and do it well?**
   - A. Work in a flexible way.
   - B. Learn from mistakes.
   - C. Avoid multitasking.
   - D. Increase efficiency.

Part IV 翻译 (Translation)

Directions: For this part, you are allowed 30 minutes to translate a passage from Chinese into English. You should write your answer on Answer Sheet 2.

改革开放以来，中国人的饮食(diet)发生了显著变化。过去由于经济落后，食品种类有限、数量不足，人们仅仅满足于吃得饱。如今中国经济快速发展，食品不仅更加丰富多样，质量也大幅提高。随着生活水平不断提升，人们对饮食的要求越来越高，更加注重吃得营养健康。因此，目前市场上推出的低脂、低糖、有机食品受到人们的普遍欢迎。

建议时间：30 分钟 | 分值：15

作答区